

6 Explain the concept of arithmetic coding and illustrate its process with an example of compressing the string ABABABBB.

Arithmetic coding is a lossless data compression technique used in data compression systems. Unlike fixed length or variable-length codes, arithmetic coding represents an entire message as a single fractional number between 0 and 1.

Instead of assigning separate bit codes to symbols, arithmetic coding progressively narrows a range $[low, high]$ based on symbol probability until the final interval uniquely represents the message.

The cumulative probabilities of symbols are represented on a line from 0.0 to 1.0. Each symbol occupies a subrange proportional to its probability.

$$\text{New range} = s + P(c) \times R$$

s = cumulative probability of previous symbols

$P(c)$ = Probability of current symbol

R = current range (high-low)

Input string = ABABABBB

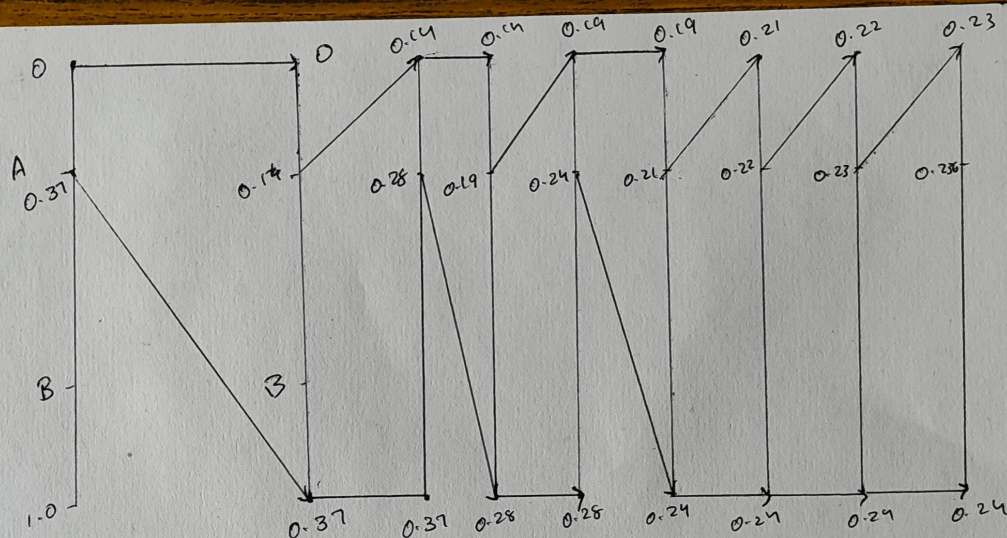
Number of A = 3

Number of B = 5

Probability of A = $3/8 = 0.375$

Probability of B = $5/8 = 0.625$

$F_1(A) = 0.375$ $F_1(B) = 1.0$



$$\begin{aligned} \text{i)} \quad S + P(A) \times R \\ = 0 + 0.37 \times 0.37 \\ = 0.14 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{ii)} \quad S + P(B) \times R \\ = 0.14 + 0.62 \times 0.23 \\ = 0.28 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{iii)} \quad S + P(A) \times R \\ = 0.14 + 0.37 \times 0.14 \\ = 0.19 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{iv)} \quad S + P(B) \times R \\ = 0.19 + 0.62 \times 0.09 \\ = 0.24 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{v)} \quad S + P(A) \times R \\ = 0.19 + 0.37 \times 0.05 \\ = 0.20 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{vi)} \quad S + P(B) \times R \\ = 0.21 + 0.62 \times 0.03 \\ = 0.22 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{vii)} \quad S + P(B) \times R \\ = 0.22 + 0.62 \times 0.02 \\ = 0.23 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{viii)} \quad S + P(B) \times R \\ = 0.23 + 0.62 \times 0.01 \\ = 0.2362 \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Tag} = \frac{0.23 + 0.24}{2} = \underline{\underline{0.235}}$$

Arithmetic coding generates a unique tag for a sequence without building codes for all sequence of length n unlike Huffman coding.

The interval is repeatedly symbolized into the same proportions as the original range.

The advantages are high compression efficiency than Huffman coding and close to entropy limit.